

لفظ سے خط تک

URDU FOR POETRY LOVERS

VOLUME 3 • LEARN TO READ THE SCRIPT

*The Urdu alphabet through 200 familiar poetry words,
joining patterns and guided couplet reading*

Prepared for

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The Script Is Not Forty Separate Problems

You already know the sound and meaning of 200 Urdu words. Volume 3 reverses the usual method: instead of memorising letters in isolation, you attach letter-shapes to words already alive in your ear.

1 • Recognise • See a familiar whole word before naming every letter.

2 • Segment • Move right to left and mark dots, non-joiners and recurring bodies.

3 • Predict • Use meaning, metre and context to supply short vowels that Urdu normally omits.

4 • Confirm • Return to Roman Urdu only after making your own reading attempt.

Your target • By the end, read familiar ghazal vocabulary directly, identify the architecture of an unfamiliar word, and follow ten complete couplets in Nastaliq without depending continuously on Roman text.

Three Rules That Remove Most Fear

DIRECTION	SHORT VOWELS	JOINING
Urdu runs right to left; numbers still run left to right.	Most a/i/u sounds are not written. The reader reconstructs them from vocabulary and grammar.	Letters change posture depending on neighbours, but their dots and skeletal family remain reliable.

The Complete Urdu Letter Map

Use this as a recognition chart, not a one-day memorisation list. Sound labels are practical Indo-Urdu approximations.

LETTER	NAME	COMMON SOUND	VISUAL CLUE	POETRY ANCHOR
ا	alif	a / aa; vowel carrier	does not join forward	آج • aaj
ب	be	b	one dot below	بہار • bahaar
پ	pe	p	three dots below	پیار • pyaar
ت	te	t	two dots above	تم • tum
ٹ	ṭe	hard retroflex ṭ	small ط above	ٹوٹنا • tootna
ث	se	s in Urdu	three dots above	اثر • asar
ج	jeem	j	one dot below	جان • jaan
چ	che	ch	three dots below	چاند • chaand
ح	ḥe	soft h	no dot	حال • haal
خ	khe	kh	one dot above	خواب • khwaab
د	daal	d	non-joiner	دل • dil
ڈ	ḍaal	hard retroflex ḍ	small ط above	ڈھونڈنا • dhoondna

LETTER	NAME	COMMON SOUND	VISUAL CLUE	POETRY ANCHOR
ذ	zaal	z in Urdu	dot above; non-joiner	ذکر • zikr
ر	re	r	non-joiner	راز • raaz
ڑ	re	retroflex ɽ	small ط above	پڑنا • paṛhna
ز	ze	z	dot above; non-joiner	زندگی • zindagi
ژ	zhe	zh	three dots; uncommon	مژہ • mizha
س	seen	s	three teeth	سفر • safar
ش	sheen	sh	three dots above	شعر • sher
ص	suaad	s	heavy historical shape	صبر • sabr
ض	zuaad	z in Urdu	dot above	ضروری • zaroori
ط	to'e	t in Urdu	upright crown	طلب • talab
ظ	zo'e	z in Urdu	dot above	ظلم • zulm
ع	ain	throat onset / vowel carrier	shape changes strongly	عشق • ishq
غ	ghain	gh	dot above	غم • gham
ف	fe	f	one dot above	فراق • firaaq
ق	qaaf	q / deep k	two dots above	قسمت • qismat

LETTER	NAME	COMMON SOUND	VISUAL CLUE	POETRY ANCHOR
ک	kaaf	k	Urdu kaaf shape	کیا • kya
گ	gaaf	g	extra stroke above	گل • gul
ل	laam	l	tall rising stroke	لب • lab
م	meem	m	rounded head	محبت • mohabbat
ن	noon	n	one dot above	نظر • nazar
ں	noon ghunna	nasal vowel	usually at word end	کہاں • kahaan
و	waao	v / w / oo / o / au	non-joiner	وفا • wafa
ہ	gol he	h; final -a/-e in some words	rounded Urdu form	ہم • ham
ھ	do-chashmi he	makes bh, ph, th, kh...	joins a consonant	پھر • phir
ء	hamza	vowel break	often sits on a carrier	آئینہ • aaina
ی	chhoti ye	y / ee	two dots below initially	یاد • yaad
ے	bari ye	e / ai	mostly final	میرے • mere

Family 1 • One body, changing dots

ب پ ت ٹ ث

BE • PE • TE • ĤE • SE

Recognition idea • The bowl is the body. Dots—or the small ĥ marker—choose the letter.

Four words already in your ear

دل بے قرار	dil beqaraar • a restless heart
پھر	phir • again
تم	tum • you
تقدیر	taqdeer • destiny

Trace it with the eye

Read each word from the right edge. Identify the target family first; then notice where the pen-line joins, falls or restarts. Say the word aloud twice before checking its meaning.

Micro-test • Cover the Roman column. Can you distinguish all four word-shapes in under ten seconds?

Family 2 • The curved cup

ج چ ح خ

JEEM • CHE • HE • KHE

Recognition idea • Keep the cup; move or multiply the dot. He has none, khe has one above.

Four words already in your ear

جان	jaan • life / beloved
چاند	chaand • moon
حال	haal • condition
خواب	khwaab • dream

Trace it with the eye

Read each word from the right edge. Identify the target family first; then notice where the pen-line joins, falls or restarts. Say the word aloud twice before checking its meaning.

Micro-test • Cover the Roman column. Can you distinguish all four word-shapes in under ten seconds?

Family 3 • The nine breakers

اوڈرٹززو

ALIF • DAAL FAMILY • RE FAMILY • WAAO

Recognition idea • These letters accept a join from the right but do not connect to the next letter on their left. A word may therefore look visually broken without containing a space.

Four words already in your ear

آرزو	aarzu • longing
درد	dard • pain
راز	raaz • secret
وفا	wafa • fidelity

Trace it with the eye

Read each word from the right edge. Identify the target family first; then notice where the pen-line joins, falls or restarts. Say the word aloud twice before checking its meaning.

Micro-test • Cover the Roman column. Can you distinguish all four word-shapes in under ten seconds?

Family 4 • Teeth and dots

س ش

SEEN • SHEEN

Recognition idea • Seen has three teeth; sheen is the same path crowned by three dots.

Four words already in your ear

سفر	safar • journey
سحر	sahar • dawn
شب	shab • night
شکوہ	shikwa • complaint

Trace it with the eye

Read each word from the right edge. Identify the target family first; then notice where the pen-line joins, falls or restarts. Say the word aloud twice before checking its meaning.

Micro-test • Cover the Roman column. Can you distinguish all four word-shapes in under ten seconds?

Family 5 • The broad emphatics

ص ض ط ظ

SUAAD • ZUAAD • TO'E • ZO'E

Recognition idea • Modern Urdu often pronounces these like ordinary s, z and t. Reading is about recognising the spelling, not forcing Arabic pronunciation.

Four words already in your ear

صبر	sabr • patience
ضروری	zaroori • necessary
طلب	talab • seeking
ظلم	zulm • cruelty

Trace it with the eye

Read each word from the right edge. Identify the target family first; then notice where the pen-line joins, falls or restarts. Say the word aloud twice before checking its meaning.

Micro-test • Cover the Roman column. Can you distinguish all four word-shapes in under ten seconds?

Family 6 • The inward throat

ع غ

AIN • GHAIN

Recognition idea • Ain is a shape-shifter and often carries a vowel. One dot turns it into ghain.

Four words already in your ear

عشق	ishq • intense love
عالم	aalam • world / state
غم	gham • sorrow
غزل	ghazal • ghazal

Trace it with the eye

Read each word from the right edge. Identify the target family first; then notice where the pen-line joins, falls or restarts. Say the word aloud twice before checking its meaning.

Micro-test • Cover the Roman column. Can you distinguish all four word-shapes in under ten seconds?

Family 7 • Loops, bowls and tall strokes

ف ق ک گل

FE • QAAF • KAAF • GAAF • LAAM

Recognition idea • Learn these through whole words; Nastaliq compresses their strokes beautifully.

Four words already in your ear

فراق	firaaq • separation
قسمت	qismat • fate
کرم	karam • grace
گل	gul • flower

Trace it with the eye

Read each word from the right edge. Identify the target family first; then notice where the pen-line joins, falls or restarts. Say the word aloud twice before checking its meaning.

Micro-test • Cover the Roman column. Can you distinguish all four word-shapes in under ten seconds?

Family 8 • The anchors

م ن ن

MEEM • NOON • NOON GHUNNA

Recognition idea • Meem makes a rounded knot. Noon has one dot; dotless final noon ghunna nasalises the preceding vowel.

Four words already in your ear

محبت	mohabbat • love
منزل	manzil • destination
نظر	nazar • gaze
کہاں	kahaan • where

Trace it with the eye

Read each word from the right edge. Identify the target family first; then notice where the pen-line joins, falls or restarts. Say the word aloud twice before checking its meaning.

Micro-test • Cover the Roman column. Can you distinguish all four word-shapes in under ten seconds?

Family 9 • Breath and aspiration



GOL HE • DO-CHASHMI HE

Recognition idea • Gol he may sound h or help mark a final vowel. Do-chashmi he combines with the previous consonant: ph, bh, th, dh, kh, gh.

Four words already in your ear

ہم	ham • we
ہجر	hijr • separation
پھر	phir • again
دیکھنا	dekhna • to see

Trace it with the eye

Read each word from the right edge. Identify the target family first; then notice where the pen-line joins, falls or restarts. Say the word aloud twice before checking its meaning.

Micro-test • Cover the Roman column. Can you distinguish all four word-shapes in under ten seconds?

Family 10 • Ye, hamza and the final glide

یے

CHHOTI YE • BAṢI YE • HAMZA

Recognition idea • Chhoti ye carries y/ee; baṣi ye is mainly final e/ai. Hamza separates adjacent vowel sounds.

Four words already in your ear

یاد	yaad • memory
زندگی	zindagi • life
میرے	mere • my / mine
آئینہ	aaina • mirror

Trace it with the eye

Read each word from the right edge. Identify the target family first; then notice where the pen-line joins, falls or restarts. Say the word aloud twice before checking its meaning.

Micro-test • Cover the Roman column. Can you distinguish all four word-shapes in under ten seconds?

Vowels • What Is Written and What You Supply

Urdu is an abjad-based script: consonants carry the structure, while short vowels are usually inferred. Long vowels and diphthongs are more visible.

SOUND	USUAL SIGN	FAMILIAR WORDS	READING STRATEGY
short a	usually omitted	دل • dil; صبر • sabr	Learn the whole word.
short i	usually omitted	عشق • ishq; قسمت • qismat	Context supplies i.
short u	usually omitted	گل • gul; ظلم • zulm	Context supplies u.
aa	ا or آ	راز • raaz; آج • aaj	Alif lengthens or carries the opening vowel.
ee	ی	زندگی • zindagi	Final/medial ye often carries ee.
oo	و	خوشبو • khushboo	Waaoo may be consonant or vowel.
e / ai	ے or ی	میرے • mere; غیر • ghair	Spelling and known word decide.
o / au	و	ہوش • hosh; موت • maut	Waaoo carries several vowel values.

Optional vowel marks

zabar • short a above

zer • short i below

pesh • short u above

jazm • no vowel after the consonant

tashdeed • double the consonant

Joining • Read the Pen-Line, Not Printed Boxes

A letter may stand alone, begin, sit in the middle or close a word. Nastaliq also slopes diagonally, so shapes nest rather than sitting on a mechanical baseline.

ALONE	BEGINNING	MIDDLE	END	NAME
ب	ب	ب	ب	be
ج	ج	ج	ج	jeem
س	س	س	س	seen
ع	ع	ع	ع	ain
م	م	م	م	meem
ی	ی	ی	ی	ye

The breaker rule • After ا و ڈ ز ر ژ ش و, the following letter begins a fresh pen-stroke. This is not a word-space. In آرزو, the visual restarts are part of one word.

A four-step word anatomy

- 1 • **Right edge** • Locate the first visible letter.
- 2 • **Dots** • Use dot count and position to select the family member.
- 3 • **Breakers** • Mark every place where joining must stop.
- 4 • **Vowel guess** • Test a familiar word that fits the consonant skeleton and context.

Reading Lab • 100 Familiar Words

Each page is a timed recognition set. Cover the Roman and meaning columns, read the Urdu aloud, then uncover to confirm. The selection intentionally mixes content words and grammatical glue.

Scoring • 2 points for instant reading, 1 for reading after segmenting, 0 if Roman Urdu was needed. Aim for 16/20 before moving on.

Recognition Set 1 • Words 1–10

#	URDU	ROMAN	MEANING	MY SCORE
1	عشق	ishq	intense, consuming or transformative love	0 1 2
2	محبت	mohabbat	love, affection, loving attachment	0 1 2
3	دل	dil	heart; the inner seat of emotion and courage	0 1 2
4	جان	jaan	life, soul; also an intimate name for a beloved	0 1 2
5	صنم	sanam	idol; poetically, the adored beloved	0 1 2
6	محبوب	mehboob	the loved one, beloved	0 1 2
7	الفت	ulfat	affection, intimacy, loving attachment	0 1 2
8	وفا	wafa	faithfulness, loyalty, keeping faith in love	0 1 2
9	بے وفا	bewafa	unfaithful, disloyal	0 1 2
10	عاشق	aashiq	lover; one overcome by love	0 1 2

Pattern note • Circle one non-joiner, underline one repeated letter-family, and mark one vowel carrier on this page.

Recognition Set 2 • Words 11–20

#	URDU	ROMAN	MEANING	MY SCORE
11	ہجر	hijr	separation from the beloved; the state of being apart	0 1 2
12	فراق	firaaq	separation, absence and longing	0 1 2
13	جدائی	judaai	parting, separation	0 1 2
14	وصال	visaal	union, reunion or meeting with the beloved	0 1 2
15	انتظار	intezaar	waiting, expectation	0 1 2
16	یاد	yaad	memory, remembrance; the feeling of missing someone	0 1 2
17	تمنا	tamanna	desire, wish, cherished longing	0 1 2
18	حسرت	hasrat	unfulfilled desire, wistful longing, regret	0 1 2
19	آرزو	aarzu	desire, aspiration, longing	0 1 2
20	جستجو	justuju	search, quest, persistent seeking	0 1 2

Pattern note • Circle one non-joiner, underline one repeated letter-family, and mark one vowel carrier on this page.

Recognition Set 3 • Words 21–30

#	URDU	ROMAN	MEANING	MY SCORE
21	غم	gham	sorrow, grief, emotional burden	0 1 2
22	درد	dard	pain, ache, suffering	0 1 2
23	اشک	ashk	tear; a literary word for a teardrop	0 1 2
24	آنسو	aansoo	tear; the common spoken word	0 1 2
25	آہ	aah	sigh, cry of pain	0 1 2
26	سوز	soz	burning emotion, passion, pathos	0 1 2
27	رنج	ranj	grief, hurt, trouble, distress	0 1 2
28	ملاال	malaal	regret, melancholy, subdued sadness	0 1 2
29	شکوہ	shikwa	complaint, grievance, reproach	0 1 2
30	فریاد	faryaad	lament, cry for help, appeal	0 1 2

Pattern note • Circle one non-joiner, underline one repeated letter-family, and mark one vowel carrier on this page.

Recognition Set 4 • Words 31–40

#	URDU	ROMAN	MEANING	MY SCORE
31	حسن	husn	beauty, loveliness	0 1 2
32	جمال	jamaal	beauty, splendour, graceful perfection	0 1 2
33	نظر	nazar	sight, glance, attention, viewpoint	0 1 2
34	نگاہ	nigaah	gaze, look, regard	0 1 2
35	ادا	adaa	graceful style, gesture, manner, charm	0 1 2
36	ناز	naaz	charming pride, coyness, pampered delicacy	0 1 2
37	رخ	rukḥ	face; also direction or aspect	0 1 2
38	زلف	zulf	lock or tress of hair	0 1 2
39	لب	lab	lip; poetically, speech or a kiss	0 1 2
40	خوشبو	khushboo	fragrance, pleasant scent	0 1 2

Pattern note • Circle one non-joiner, underline one repeated letter-family, and mark one vowel carrier on this page.

Recognition Set 5 • Words 41–50

#	URDU	ROMAN	MEANING	MY SCORE
41	مے	mai (may)	wine; the classical poetic word	0 1 2
42	شراب	sharaab	wine, alcoholic drink	0 1 2
43	ساقی	saaqi	cupbearer, one who pours wine	0 1 2
44	پیمانہ	paimaana	measure, goblet, wine-cup	0 1 2
45	جام	jaam	goblet, cup, wine-cup	0 1 2
46	مے خانہ	maikhaana	tavern, house of wine	0 1 2
47	خمار	khumaar	lingering intoxication, dreamy after-effect	0 1 2
48	مست	mast	intoxicated, ecstatic, carefree	0 1 2
49	رند	rind	free-spirited drinker; worldly nonconformist	0 1 2
50	ہوش	hosh	consciousness, awareness, senses	0 1 2

Pattern note • Circle one non-joiner, underline one repeated letter-family, and mark one vowel carrier on this page.

Recognition Set 6 • Words 51–60

#	URDU	ROMAN	MEANING	MY SCORE
51	میں	main	I; the speaker referring to oneself	0 1 2
52	ہم	ham	we; sometimes a dignified poetic I	0 1 2
53	تو	tu	you; intimate, familiar, devotional or disrespectful by context	0 1 2
54	تم	tum	you; familiar and widely used	0 1 2
55	آپ	aap	you; respectful or formal	0 1 2
56	وہ	woh	that; he, she or they by context	0 1 2
57	یہ	yeh	this; he, she or they nearby by context	0 1 2
58	کوئی	koi	someone, anyone, some	0 1 2
59	سب	sab	all, everyone, everything	0 1 2
60	خود	khud	self; oneself; personally	0 1 2

Pattern note • Circle one non-joiner, underline one repeated letter-family, and mark one vowel carrier on this page.

Recognition Set 7 • Words 61–70

#	URDU	ROMAN	MEANING	MY SCORE
61	کا	ka	of; belonging to, used with a masculine singular noun	0 1 2
62	کی	ki	of; belonging to, used with a feminine noun	0 1 2
63	کے	ke	of; belonging to, used with masculine plural or oblique forms	0 1 2
64	کو	ko	to; toward; marks a recipient or object	0 1 2
65	سے	se	from, with, by, than	0 1 2
66	میں	mein	in, inside, within	0 1 2
67	پر	par	on, upon, at; sometimes but	0 1 2
68	تک	tak	until, up to, as far as	0 1 2
69	لیے	liye	for; for the sake of	0 1 2
70	بغیر	baghair	without	0 1 2

Pattern note • Circle one non-joiner, underline one repeated letter-family, and mark one vowel carrier on this page.

Recognition Set 8 • Words 71–80

#	URDU	ROMAN	MEANING	MY SCORE
71	جو	jo	who, which, that; the one who	0 1 2
72	جب	jab	when	0 1 2
73	اگر	agar	if	0 1 2
74	مگر	magar	but, however	0 1 2
75	لیکن	lekin	but, however	0 1 2
76	ورنہ	warna	otherwise; or else	0 1 2
77	پھر	phir	again; then; after that	0 1 2
78	اب	ab	now	0 1 2
79	بھی	bhi	also, too, even	0 1 2
80	ہی	hi	indeed, precisely, only	0 1 2

Pattern note • Circle one non-joiner, underline one repeated letter-family, and mark one vowel carrier on this page.

Recognition Set 9 • Words 81–90

#	URDU	ROMAN	MEANING	MY SCORE
81	کیا	kya	what; also a question marker	0 1 2
82	کیوں	kyun	why	0 1 2
83	کیسے	kaise	how; in what manner	0 1 2
84	کون	kaun	who	0 1 2
85	کہاں	kahan	where	0 1 2
86	کب	kab	when	0 1 2
87	نہیں	nahin	not; no	0 1 2
88	نہ	na	not; do not; or, in repeated alternatives	0 1 2
89	مت	mat	do not; prohibitive marker	0 1 2
90	گویا	goya	as if, so to speak	0 1 2

Pattern note • Circle one non-joiner, underline one repeated letter-family, and mark one vowel carrier on this page.

Recognition Set 10 • Words 91–100

#	URDU	ROMAN	MEANING	MY SCORE
91	آج	aaj	today	0 1 2
92	کل	kal	yesterday or tomorrow; context decides	0 1 2
93	کبھی	kabhi	sometimes, ever, at some time	0 1 2
94	ہمیشہ	hamesha	always	0 1 2
95	یہاں	yahan	here	0 1 2
96	وہاں	wahan	there	0 1 2
97	کہیں	kahin	somewhere, anywhere; sometimes perhaps	0 1 2
98	پاس	paas	near, beside; in one's possession	0 1 2
99	دور	door	far, distant	0 1 2
100	سامنے	saamne	in front of, before, face-to-face	0 1 2

Pattern note • Circle one non-joiner, underline one repeated letter-family, and mark one vowel carrier on this page.

Ten Couplets • Script-First Reading

These classical couplets appeared with full interpretation in Volume 2. Here the task changes: let the Nastaliq line lead, use the consonant skeleton and familiar words, then consult the Roman bridge.

01 • MIRZA GHALIB

دلِ ناداں تجھے ہوا کیا ہے
آخر اس درد کی دوا کیا ہے

dil-e-naadaan tujhe hua kya hai
aakhir is dard ki dawa kya hai

Words to catch • dil • naadaan • dard • dawa • kya • hona

Script task • Mark non-joiners; identify two letter-families; then read both lines aloud without Roman support.

Meaning bridge • Naive heart, what has happened to you? After all, what is the remedy for this pain?

02 • MIRZA GHALIB

ہزاروں خواہشیں ایسی کہ ہر خواہش پہ دم نکلے
بہت نکلے مرے ارمان لیکن پھر بھی کم نکلے

hazaaron khwaahishen aisi ki har khwaahish pe dam nikle
bahut nikle mere armaan lekin phir bhi kam nikle

Words to catch • khwaahish • armaan • lekin • phir • bhi • kam

Script task • Mark non-joiners; identify two letter-families; then read both lines aloud without Roman support.

Meaning bridge • Thousands of desires, each worth a life-breath; many longings emerged, yet even then they proved too few.

03 • MIRZA GHALIB

ان کے دیکھے سے جو آ جاتی ہے منہ پر رونق
وہ سمجھتے ہیں کہ بیمار کا حال اچھا ہے

*un ke dekhe se jo aa jaati hai munh par raunaq
woh samajhte hain ki bimaar ka haal achchha hai*

Words to catch • dekhna • se • jo • aana • par • haal • achchha

Script task • Mark non-joiners; identify two letter-families; then read both lines aloud without Roman support.

Meaning bridge • The radiance that comes to the face on seeing them—they assume the sick person's condition is good.

04 • MIRZA GHALIB

رنج سے خوگر ہوا انساں تو مٹ جاتا ہے رنج
مشکلیں مجھ پر پڑیں اتنی کہ آساں ہو گئیں

*ranj se khugar hua insaan to mit jaata hai ranj
mushkilen mujh par padin itni ki aasan ho gayin*

Words to catch • ranj • se • par • mushkil • aasan • hona

Script task • Mark non-joiners; identify two letter-families; then read both lines aloud without Roman support.

Meaning bridge • When a person becomes accustomed to grief, grief disappears; so many difficulties fell upon me that they became easy.

05 • MIRZA GHALIB

ریختے کے تمہیں استاد نہیں ہو غالب
کہتے ہیں اگلے زمانے میں کوئی میر بھی تھا

rekhte ke tumhin ustaad nahin ho Ghalib
kehthe hain agle zamaane mein koi Mir bhi tha

Words to catch • tum • hi • nahin • kehna • zamaana • mein • koi • bhi

Script task • Mark non-joiners; identify two letter-families; then read both lines aloud without Roman support.

Meaning bridge • Ghalib, you alone are not the master of Rekhta; they say that in an earlier age there was a Mir too.

06 • MEER TAQI MEER

عشق اک میر بھاری پتھر ہے
کب یہ تجھ ناتواں سے اٹھتا ہے

ishq ik Mir bhaari patthar hai
kab yeh tujh na-tawaan se uthta hai

Words to catch • ishq • kab • yeh • tu • se • hona

Script task • Mark non-joiners; identify two letter-families; then read both lines aloud without Roman support.

Meaning bridge • Love, Mir, is a heavy stone; when could it be lifted by frail you?

07 • MEER TAQI MEER

پتتا پتتا بوٹا بوٹا حال ہمارا جانے ہے
جانے نہ جانے گل ہی نہ جانے باغ تو سارا جانے ہے

patta patta boota boota haal hamaara jaane hai
jaane na jaane gul hi na jaane baagh to saara jaane hai

Words to catch • haal • ham • na • hi • sab • khabar

Script task • Mark non-joiners; identify two letter-families; then read both lines aloud without Roman support.

Meaning bridge • Every leaf and plant knows our condition; know or not, only the flower does not know—the whole garden knows.

08 • MEER TAQI MEER

سرہانے میر کے کوئی نہ بولو
ابھی ٹک روتے روتے سو گیا ہے

sirhaane Mir ke koi na bolo
abhi tuk rote rote so gaya hai

Words to catch • koi • na • kehna • rona • ab • hona

Script task • Mark non-joiners; identify two letter-families; then read both lines aloud without Roman support.

Meaning bridge • Speak not beside Mir's pillow; only just now, weeping and weeping, he has fallen asleep.

09 • MEER TAQI MEER

ہم ہوئے تم ہوئے کہ میر ہوئے
اس کی زلفوں کے سب اسیر ہوئے

*ham hue tum hue ki Mir hue
us ki zulfon ke sab aseer hue*

Words to catch • ham • tum • ki • ke • sab • hona • zulf

Script task • Mark non-joiners; identify two letter-families; then read both lines aloud without Roman support.

Meaning bridge • Whether we, you, or Mir—all became captives of that person's tresses.

10 • MEER TAQI MEER

لگا نہ دل کو کہیں کیا سنا نہیں تو نے
جو کچھ کہ میر کا اس عاشقی نے حال کیا

*laga na dil ko kahin kya suna nahin tu ne
jo kuchh ki Mir ka is aashiqi ne haal kiya*

Words to catch • na • dil • ko • kahin • kya • nahin • tu • ne • haal • karna

Script task • Mark non-joiners; identify two letter-families; then read both lines aloud without Roman support.

Meaning bridge • Do not attach the heart anywhere—have you not heard what this loving did to Mir's condition?

A Six-Week Script Practice Plan

WEEK	FOCUS	DAILY OUTPUT
1	Direction, dots, Families 1–2	Read 15 known words daily
2	Non-joiners, Families 3–5	Mark every pen-line restart
3	Families 6–10	Read word bodies before names
4	Vowels and joining	Recognition Sets 1–5
5	Fluency	Recognition Sets 6–10
6	Couplets	Two script-first couplets daily

The daily 20-minute loop

5 min • Shape • Review one family and write its letters once.

5 min • Words • Read one ten-word recognition set.

5 min • Sound • Listen to or recite one couplet while following the Urdu line.

5 min • Recall • Write three familiar words from memory; compare letter order and dots.

Completion test

Ready for Volume 4 when • You can score at least 80/100 in the Reading Lab, name the nine non-joiners, read five familiar compounds directly, and follow one complete couplet with no Roman Urdu on the first pass.

What Volume 4 Can Unlock

آواز، آہنگ اور غزل

Once script recognition becomes comfortable, the next step is not more alphabet. It is poetic craft: syllable weight, metre, radīf, qāfiyah, ghazal architecture, rhetorical devices, symbolism and performance.

Metre • Hear long and short syllabic weight without turning poetry into mathematics.

Rhyme architecture • Locate qāfiyah and radīf, then see how poets create surprise inside repetition.

Poetic devices • Recognise metaphor, ambiguity, paradox, allusion, personification and the dramatic turn.

Interpretation • Move from literal meaning to image, voice, cultural resonance and multiple plausible readings.

Final reminder

Do not postpone poetry until your reading is perfect. Follow the script while listening, guess generously, and let familiar words become islands from which the rest of the line slowly emerges.